

Learn the commercials from a stream

Cable channels play the same national commercials on their live streams as on cable. If your phone listens to that stream for a few evenings, it fills its memory with those spots **before** you ever sit down in front of the TV, and it learns from clean audio rather than a noisy living room. This guide shows how to make the phone listen to **its own playback** while a stream plays, how to move what it learned to another phone, and what a stream can and cannot teach.

Android 10 or newer · AdHush 0.19 · MS NOW, Xfinity Stream, or any channel with a live stream

Read this first

Nothing is recorded. The phone keeps fingerprints (numbers that describe a few seconds of sound) and the words it heard, never the audio itself, and nothing leaves the phone. You will be asked by Android whether AdHush may “record or cast” the screen; that permission is how Android lets one app hear another app’s sound, and AdHush uses only the sound. Keep the phone plugged in: a few hours of listening is a few hours of screen-on time.

Time: ten minutes to set up, then evenings of listening in the background. Needs: the AdHush app, a channel you can stream (a membership, your cable login, or a free stream), and Android 10 or newer.

What a stream can teach, and what it cannot

On the stream	On cable	What the phone learns
The channel’s own national spots	The same recordings	Yes. Fingerprints and, with Speech on, the words. Recognised next time they air on cable.
Ads inserted by the streaming service	Your cable company’s local ads instead	Learned, but never seen on cable. Harmless: they simply never match.
The show itself	The same show, about half a minute earlier	Nothing; and the stream is too late to be the live sensor.
The break clock (method 9)	—	Not from a stream: the delay would shift every minute. The clock learns only at the TV.

The stream is a teacher, not a sensor. When you are done teaching, you Stop, and the normal AdHush at the TV uses everything the stream taught it. The two share one memory.

1 Get the stream playing on the phone

1. Open the channel’s live stream in **Chrome**: the MS NOW site with your membership, the Xfinity Stream site with your cable login, or any network’s live page. Chrome lets other apps hear its sound.

2. Apps work too when they allow it. If an app blocks capture, AdHush hears silence and will tell you within a minute; switch to the web player in Chrome.
3. Turn the phone's volume down or off if you like: capture takes the sound before the speaker, so a silent phone still teaches.

Android pauses most web video when you leave the browser. Keep the player on screen, or use the player's picture-in-picture button so it floats while you do other things. Screen brightness can be at its lowest.

2 Start stream learning

1. In AdHush, open **Methods** and scroll to the card **Learn from a stream**.
2. Check that **Speech** (card 5) is on if you want the words learned too; the speech model must be installed. Remembered breaks are always on for stream learning.
3. Tap **Start learning from a stream**. Android asks whether AdHush may record or cast; choose the whole screen and allow. (AdHush only takes the sound.)
4. Go back to the stream. The AdHush notification now reads *STREAM LEARNING* with the time listened and the breaks learned so far.

Leave it. Every commercial the phone recognises as a commercial, by the quiet gap, the loudness jump, a known script or an AI judge, is fingerprinted when it ends. A commercial is learned once; the next airing only confirms it.

3 Help it along while you watch

If you are watching the stream anyway, the two buttons on the notification teach it faster than anything else. When a break starts, tap ✓ **Is an ad**; when the show returns, tap ► **Show's back**. The whole break between the taps is remembered, spot by spot. Ten breaks taught this way cover most of what a channel plays in a week.

If it called part of the show a commercial, tap ✗ **Not an ad**. Nothing was ducked, because there is no TV in this mode, but the wrong fingerprint is dropped.

4 Stop, then use it at the TV

1. Tap ■ **Stop** on the notification or on Home. The notification's last line tells you how many breaks and scripts the session added.
2. Put the phone where it lives by the TV and tap ► **Start** as usual. Everything the stream taught is in the same memory; card 3 shows the count.

5 Move the memory to another phone

Learned on the OnePlus, wanted on the Moto? On card **3. Remembered breaks**:

1. On the phone that learned, tap **Share this phone's memory** and send the file (`adhush-memory.zip`) to yourself: mail, Drive, messages, anything.
2. On the other phone, stop AdHush if it is running, open the same card, tap **Import memory from a file**, and pick the file.
3. The two memories are merged: breaks, scripts and the break clock. Nothing already known is doubled.

The Raspberry Pi listener cannot use this file yet: its fingerprint matcher works from the camera picture first and the sound second, so a memory made of sound alone means nothing to it. Teaching the Pi still happens at the TV with ✓ and ►.

? Which streams work

1. **MS NOW membership** (\$7.99 a month): the live channel in Chrome. The one you bought works until the month ends, cancelled or not.
2. **Xfinity Stream** (included with your cable): the live channels in Chrome with your Xfinity login. The ad breaks are the closest match to what your TV plays, because it is the same company.
3. **Network sites and apps** that stream live with a cable login: CNN, Fox News, the broadcast networks' live feeds. Any of them teaches that channel's spots.
4. **Free streams with commercials** (Pluto TV, Tubi, the networks' free news streams) teach their own ads, which overlap only partly with cable. Cheap practice, less payoff.

Fix-it table

What you see	What to do
<i>needs Android 10</i>	Hearing another app's sound is an Android 10 feature. On an older phone, play the stream on a laptop next to the phone and use the ordinary Start instead: the mic learns the same spots, less cleanly.
<i>hearing nothing from the player</i>	The app blocks capture. Use the channel's web player in Chrome, or the laptop trick above.
The stream stops when the screen goes off	Keep the screen on with the brightness down, or use picture-in-picture. Plug the phone in.
Hours listened, zero breaks learned	A stream with its own ad-free stretches, or breaks the quiet-gap and loudness methods cannot see on that channel. Teach ten breaks by hand with ✓ and ►, or switch on an AI judge (card 7 or 8) for the session.
<i>stop AdHush first</i> when importing	The memory is read when AdHush starts, so it must be stopped to change it. Stop, import, Start.
It ducks the TV during the show for a spot it learned from the stream	Tap X Not an ad : that fingerprint is forgotten.

AdHush is free software (MIT). This guide matches AdHush 0.19 on Android. Stream learning uses Android's playback-capture permission to hear the phone's own audio; it stores fingerprints and words, never sound, and uploads nothing. Streaming services' terms allow personal viewing; AdHush neither records nor redistributes anything, it only remembers what a commercial sounds like, as you would.